

a distribution and experience it, before turning it into their primary operating system.

Experimenting with previews or developer versions: If you tinker around frequently with developer versions of Linux distributions or preview versions of the Windows operating system, using a virtual machine is a better approach. The reason for this is solely because the operating system is in its development stage, which could be unstable (potential to mess up hardware devices) and also have some services or features that are not functional yet.

Running potentially harmful software: You come across a fascinating software but you aren't sure whether it is legit or it could be a virus or malware. Running this piece of mysterious software inside a virtual machine would be safer since the virtual machines are sandboxed, that is they are isolated from the rest of your computer. This ensures that the potentially harmful program doesn't cause any damage to your system.

Testing software on different operating systems: So you've developed a new software and want to see if it works fine on other platforms as well. Rather than having many computers running the targeted operating systems, you can install them on a virtual machine so that you can run and test the software on different Linux distributions or even different versions of Windows.

Using an outdated software: Some software can't be installed and run on current operating systems due to compatibility issues. This stands as a problem if you have a licensed copy of a certain software made to run only on specific versions of operating systems. Using an old or outdated operating system can pose as a risk due to the discontinued support, and also because current laptops and hardware devices won't fully support the old version. So the better way out would be to install the required operating system in a virtual machine.

Running software intended for other operating systems: Not all software are released for every platform, and there are some which you can't wait to use. You can run a virtual machine on your Mac, to run any Windows or Linux software, without having to install Wine or other pro-